# The Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity

Dynamics

**Abstract**

This paper states the dynamical content of Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity, the exact-closure theory of Æther / Æther-flow framework. The choice made here is explicit: this is an exact-closure dynamics manuscript, not a candidate-derivation manuscript. The Æther / Æther-flow ontology is retained as the conceptual foundation of the framework, but the effective gravitational dynamics are taken to be exactly those of general relativity with universal matter coupling.

The purpose of the paper is therefore not to claim that Einsteinian gravity has already been derived from substrate microphysics. Its purpose is narrower and more disciplined. First, it states the closed effective action and field equations of Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity. Second, it records the matter-coupling and effective-metric rules that define the theory operationally. Third, it explains in what sense Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity is already a theory and in what sense the deeper substrate derivation remains open. The result is a clean dynamical benchmark for the wider Æther / Æther-flow program and the exact reference point for any later extension of the framework.

## 1. Introduction

The foundations manuscript fixes the ontological core of Æther / Æther-flow framework: the Æther is the underlying four-dimensional substrate of reality, the Æther-flow is its intrinsic ordered motion, observed three-dimensional space is the local experiential slice of that deeper substrate, and S-time is the experienced order of change arising from the relation between matter, light, and the Æther-flow. The present paper adds the next required layer: it states the dynamical content of Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity.

**Framework and claim boundary.** Æther / Æther-flow framework denotes the broader Æther / Æther-flow framework built on the claims that the Æther is the underlying four-dimensional substrate of reality, the Æther-flow is its intrinsic ordered motion, observed three-dimensional space is the local experiential slice of that deeper substrate, S-time is the experienced order of change arising from matter, light, and the Æther-flow, and observed expansion is the three-dimensional appearance of deeper four-dimensional ordered motion. Within that framework, Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity denotes the exact-closure theory in which the effective gravitational dynamics are adopted to be exactly Einsteinian with universal matter coupling. In the active sequence, *adoption* means use of that established relativistic dynamics without claiming substrate derivation, while *derivation* is reserved for a first-principles recovery from explicit substrate variables.

The present manuscript therefore makes one clean choice. Either Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity is presented as an exact-closure theory whose effective dynamics are stated directly, or it

is presented as a candidate-derivation theory built from one explicit substrate-level model. The present manuscript chooses the first route. That choice is scientifically safer and conceptually cleaner at the current stage of the repository, because the exact benchmark has already been identified while no substrate derivation has yet been established at comparable rigor.

Accordingly, this paper should not be read as a partial derivation paper disguised as a dynamics paper. It is instead the exact-closure dynamics statement of Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity. The theory is closed because its effective action, field equations, matter coupling, null structure, proper-time structure, and weak-field limit are all fixed exactly. What remains open is not the effective dynamics of the theory, but the deeper question of whether those dynamics can later be recovered from explicit substrate variables.

## 2. Choice of Dynamical Stance

**Definition 1** (Exact-closure dynamics manuscript)**.** *An exact-closure dynamics manuscript is a paper that states the closed effective dynamics of Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity directly, while distinguishing those adopted dynamics from any future substrate-level derivation program.*

**Remark 1.** *This differs from a candidate-derivation manuscript, which would have to specify explicit substrate variables, a substrate action, and a derivational argument showing that the effective relativistic sector follows from them in the infrared.*

The present manuscript adopts the exact-closure route for three reasons.

1. The active reference theory of the framework is already Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity, not a still-open deviation proposal.

2. The foundations layer now carries the ontological and claim-boundary load needed to support a clean dynamical statement.

3. A mixed manuscript would blur the line between adopted effective dynamics and unfinished substrate recovery, which is precisely what the current sequence is trying to avoid.

The operative consequence is straightforward. In Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity, the gravitational dynamics are taken to be Einsteinian exactly, and the Æther / Æther-flow ontology functions as deeper interpretive structure rather than as an extra low-energy propagating sector.

## 3. Definition of Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity as a Dynamical Theory

**Definition 2** (Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity)**.** *Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity is the exact-closure, GR-consistent theory of Æther / Æther-flow framework in which the Æther / Æther-flow ontology is retained while the effective gravitational dynamics are exactly those of general relativity with universal matter coupling.*

**Proposition 1.** *Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity is already a closed dynamical theory at the effective level, because its action principle, field equations, conservation law, null structure, proper-time rule, and weak-field reduction are all fixed without ambiguity.*

This proposition should be read with precision. It does not claim that the theory is microphysically complete. It claims that the theory is dynamically complete as an exact effective realization. In

other words, the theory is closed where prediction lives, even though the deeper substrate derivation remains open.

## 4. Exact Effective Action and Field Equations

The effective action of Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity is

$$S_{\text{eff}} = \frac{c^3}{16\pi G} \int d^4x \sqrt{-g}\, R + S_{\text{matter}}[g, \psi]. \tag{1}$$

Variation with respect to the effective metric $g_{\mu\nu}$ yields the Einstein equations

$$G_{\mu\nu} = \frac{8\pi G}{c^4} T_{\mu\nu}, \tag{2}$$

where the matter stress tensor is defined by

$$T_{\mu\nu} \equiv -\frac{2}{\sqrt{-g}} \frac{\delta S_{\text{matter}}}{\delta g^{\mu\nu}}. \tag{3}$$

**Corollary 1.** *The low-energy predictive content of Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity is exactly the predictive content of GR with the same matter sector.*

This is the central dynamical statement of the theory. It is not a matching approximation and not a weak-field truncation. It is the exact effective law of gravitation in Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity.

## 5. Matter Coupling and Conservation

The matter-coupling rule of Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity is universal minimal coupling to the effective metric $g_{\mu\nu}$. Matter fields therefore enter the theory through the action $S_{\text{matter}}[g, \psi]$ and not through direct low-energy couplings to an extra observable Æther-flow field.

This choice has three immediate consequences.

1. Test bodies couple to the same effective metric structure that governs gravitational dynamics.
2. The contracted Bianchi identity together with (2) implies covariant stress-energy conservation,

$$\nabla_\mu T^{\mu\nu} = 0. \tag{4}$$

3. The operational content of the equivalence principle is preserved in the same sense in which it is preserved in GR.

In particular, Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity does not introduce a second established matter metric, a direct preferred-frame matter coupling, or a low-energy matter interaction proportional to an independently measurable Æther-flow correction. The ontology is retained, but the effective matter law is the ordinary GR law.

## 6. Effective Metric Role

The effective metric is the object that carries the operational relativistic structure of the theory. Light propagation, causal structure, clock behavior, redshift, and measured duration are all governed by $g_{\mu\nu}$.

For any nonzero tangent vector $v^\mu$, the causal classification is fixed by

$$g_{\mu\nu}v^\mu v^\nu \begin{cases} < 0, & \text{timelike}, \\ = 0, & \text{null}, \\ > 0, & \text{spacelike}. \end{cases} \tag{5}$$

Null propagation satisfies

$$0 = g_{\mu\nu}\, dx^\mu dx^\nu, \tag{6}$$

while proper time along timelike histories satisfies

$$d\tau^2 = -\frac{1}{c^2} g_{\mu\nu}\, dx^\mu dx^\nu. \tag{7}$$

**Proposition 2** (Single operational geometry)**.** *In Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity, the same effective metric governs null propagation, proper time, and freely falling low-energy motion.*

Because matter is minimally and universally coupled to $g_{\mu\nu}$, freely falling test bodies satisfy the usual geodesic equation

$$u^\nu \nabla_\nu u^\mu = 0, \tag{8}$$

where $u^\mu = dx^\mu/d\tau$ is the four-velocity. At every event $p$, one may therefore choose local coordinates for which

$$g_{\mu\nu}(p) = \eta_{\mu\nu}, \qquad \partial_\alpha g_{\mu\nu}(p) = 0. \tag{9}$$

This is the precise sense in which the observed relativistic structure is exact in Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity. The theory does not ask observers to use one geometry for clocks and another for gravity. Nor does it introduce a second universally coupled low-energy cone structure. The effective metric is unique, universal, and Einsteinian.

**Remark 2.** *Within the broader ontology of Æther / Æther-flow framework, one may still interpret this effective metric as the observer-accessible manifestation of deeper substrate order. But that interpretation does not alter the exact effective equations used in Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity.*

## 7. Weak-Field and Local Relativistic Recovery

Because the effective dynamics are Einsteinian, the weak-field and local special-relativistic structures are inherited exactly. In an asymptotically inertial region one may write the linearized expansion

$$g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{\mu\nu} + h_{\mu\nu}, \qquad |h_{\mu\nu}| \ll 1. \tag{10}$$

In the static, slowly moving regime with $T_{00} \simeq \rho c^2$ dominant and the remaining stress-tensor components subleading, the Einstein equations reduce at leading order to the Poisson equation

$$\nabla^2 \Phi = 4\pi G \rho. \tag{11}$$

The weak-field metric components are then

$$h_{00} = -2\frac{\Phi}{c^2}, \qquad h_{ij} = -2\gamma \frac{\Phi}{c^2}\delta_{ij}, \tag{12}$$

so that the standard static weak-field line element becomes

$$ds^2 = -\left(1 + 2\frac{\Phi}{c^2}\right) c^2 dt^2 + \left(1 - 2\gamma\frac{\Phi}{c^2}\right) \delta_{ij}\, dx^i dx^j, \tag{13}$$

with the GR-consistent value

$$\gamma = 1. \tag{14}$$

For slowly moving test bodies, (8) reduces correspondingly to

$$\frac{d^2 x^i}{dt^2} = -\partial_i \Phi + \mathcal{O}\left(\frac{v^2}{c^2}, \frac{\Phi^2}{c^4}\right), \tag{15}$$

which is the ordinary Newtonian limit. This weak-field form is therefore not a separate subtheory inside Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity. It is the explicit static weak-field face of the exact Einsteinian closure already fixed by (1)–(2). Likewise, the local inertial condition (9) reproduces the standard special-relativistic kinematics of GR because the local effective metric structure is the same.

The conceptual significance is worth stating plainly. The Æther / Æther-flow ontology does not compete with the operational content of SR or GR in this theory. It is offered as a deeper account of what that exact relativistic structure may ultimately describe, not as a presently established correction to it. The present manuscript fixes the benchmark weak-field and local-causal structure needed for the exact dynamical statement. A fuller treatment of redshift, light-deflection observables, and the explicit SR relation belongs to the relativistic-recovery manuscript in the active sequence.

## 8. The Role of the Æther-flow in the Dynamics of Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity

In Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity, the Æther-flow does not appear as an additional low-energy propagating degree of freedom in the effective action (1). Its role is ontological, structural, and interpretive.

This means:

- the Æther-flow names the intrinsic ordered motion of the deeper substrate posited by the framework;
- it supports the interpretation of S-time as experienced order of change;
- it may motivate foliation or congruence language as a dictionary between ontology and observed relativistic structure;

- it does not generate an extra established preferred-frame signal, independent weak-field correction, or separate radiative sector in the exact-closure theory.

This restriction is not incidental. If the Æther-flow were naively promoted to an extra observable low-energy field in the present theory, the theory would cease to be exact closure and would move into a deviation sector. The whole point of Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity is to retain the ontology without pretending that such a deformation has already been justified.

## 9. Exact Closure, Benchmark Role, and Reversion Rule

**Proposition 3** (Benchmark role)**.** *Any admissible future extension of Æther / Æther-flow framework must reduce to Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity in the appropriate limit. Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity is therefore the internal control theory of Æther / Æther-flow framework.*

**Proposition 4** (Automatic reversion)**.** *If a controlled deviation theory fails an essential consistency or viability gate, the correct scientific status of the framework contracts back to Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity.*

These statements are not merely architectural. They carry direct dynamical meaning. Any future deviation sector must be compared against the exact dynamical benchmark already stated here, not against ontology alone. The theory Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity is therefore the benchmark action, benchmark field equation set, benchmark matter law, benchmark weak-field limit, and benchmark operational causal structure of the total framework.

## 10. What Is Adopted and What Remains To Be Derived

The present manuscript adopts the following statements exactly.

1. The effective metric $g_{\mu\nu}$ is the unique metric governing low-energy gravitational dynamics, matter coupling, null propagation, and proper time.
2. The effective action is the Einstein–Hilbert action plus ordinary matter, as in (1).
3. The field equations are the Einstein equations (2).
4. The weak-field and local relativistic limits are the ordinary GR limits.

The present manuscript does *not* claim the following.

1. It does not claim a completed substrate derivation of $g_{\mu\nu}$ from explicit variables on $\mathcal{A}$.
2. It does not claim that a candidate substrate action has already been shown to reproduce (1).
3. It does not claim a surviving non-GR low-energy observable sector inside Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity.

What remains open is the derivational program. In schematic form, a future substrate manuscript would have to specify explicit variables $Q$ on the deeper substrate and an action of the form

$$S_{\mathcal{A}} = \int d^4X \, \mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{A}}(Q, \partial Q, \ldots), \tag{16}$$

together with a definite map from those variables to the effective relativistic sector. One possible class of candidate ideas was already sketched in the source manuscript through a positive-definite substrate metric $G_{AB}$, an order field $S(X)$, and an induced effective Lorentzian metric. But none of that is being used here as a completed derivation. In the present paper, it remains a future target rather than part of the adopted dynamics.

## 11. Limitations

The current exact-closure dynamics statement has limits that should be made explicit.

First, it is exact at the effective level, not at the microphysical level. The theory closes the observed dynamics of gravitation, but it does not yet close the substrate derivation problem.

Second, it secures the relation to GR by adoption rather than by proof of emergence. That is legitimate at the current stage, but it is not the end of the deeper theory program.

Third, the manuscript does not attempt here to derive or analyze a specific substrate action, count substrate degrees of freedom, or prove infrared emergence. Those tasks belong to a later derivational and consistency sequence.

These limitations do not weaken the current paper's main result. They define its scope correctly.

## 12. Conclusion

This paper makes one clean choice: Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity is formulated here as the exact-closure dynamics theory of Æther / Æther-flow framework. The dynamical content of that theory is exact and explicit. Its effective action is Einstein–Hilbert plus ordinary matter. Its field equations are the Einstein equations. Its matter law is universal minimal coupling to a single effective metric. Its null, timelike, and freely falling structures are exactly relativistic. Its weak-field, Newtonian, and local inertial limits are exactly those of GR.

What the paper does *not* do is equally important. It does not present a completed substrate derivation of those dynamics. It does not smuggle an unfinished candidate model into the exact theory as if it were already established. It does not confuse ontology with derivation. The result is therefore a disciplined dynamical benchmark: Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity is a closed effective theory, a reference theory, and the exact fallback statement for the wider Æther / Æther-flow program. That is the correct starting point for any later manuscript that attempts a deeper substrate recovery.